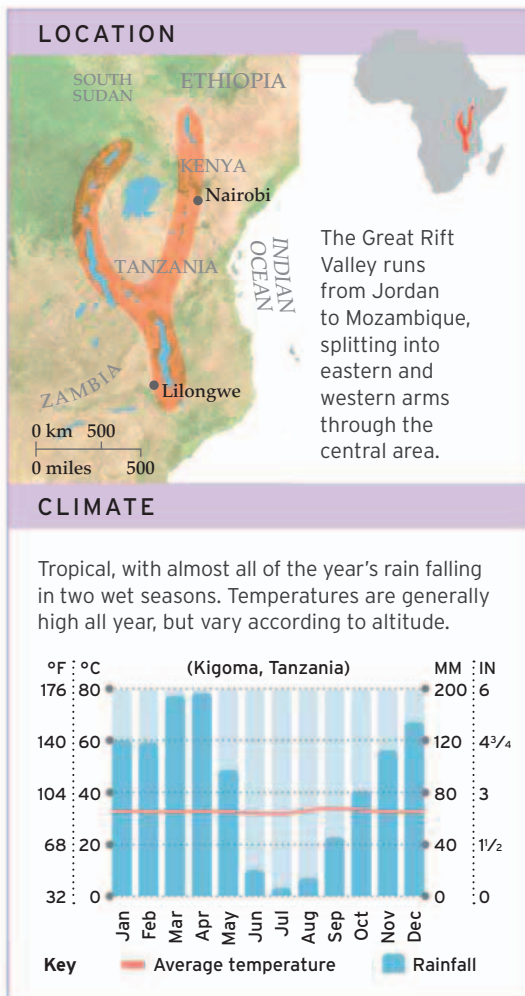




Olive baboon

Papio anubis



Ever the opportunists, these intelligent, adaptable monkeys eat virtually anything they can get their hands on, from grasses to small animals and human refuse. They are also at home in many different habitats—even where there are few trees, such as rocky hills, semidesert, and open savanna.

Baboon society

Olive baboons live in large groups of up to 120 and spend most of their time foraging on the ground, often moving in columns. Adult males weigh twice as much as females, and have longer canine teeth and an impressive neck ruff, or mane. They fight for access to sexually receptive females, but usually only a few dominant males in each group manage to mate. Females can breed throughout the year, giving birth to a single baby after a gestation of around six months. It is carried by the mother, clinging to her belly, until it is around six weeks old and strong enough to ride on her back. Infants have black fur, which changes to grayish brown within a few months.

Because of their frequent crop-raiding, olive baboons are seen as pests and are widely persecuted by farmers. Their chief natural predators are leopards.

- ↔ 20–36 in (51–91 cm)
- ⚖ 31–66 lb (14–30 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍌 Fruit, leaves, insects
- 🏠



▽ MONKEYING AROUND

Baboons are among the most playful of animals. They have an extended juvenile phase, during which they must learn the rules of their society.



Adult male baboons are **efficient hunters**—they can catch hares, baby antelopes, **even other monkeys**

WORLD'S SECOND-DEEPEST LAKE

CICHLIDS GALORE

Cichlids are famed for their diversity—Lake Malawi alone has some 800 species. Some have remarkable reproductive behaviors. Some males build elaborate nests to attract a mate, while some females are mouth brooders, carrying eggs and fry in their mouths.

CICHLID

